ENT207TC DIGITAL STARTUP LAB · WEEK 4

From prototype to build

Checkpoint 1 · Draft 1 · Choose your stack

XJTLU Entrepreneur College (Taicang)



SESSION OVERVIEW

Today's session

PART 1 · 60 MIN

Checkpoint 1

Each group presents its digital prototype to its mentor.

PART 2 · BRIEFING

Draft 1

What goes into Draft 1, and how to submit it on UnoAnalyzer.

PART 3 · REST OF SESSION

Choose your stack

Create a Softr account, start the certification and make a first stack decision.

✓ By the end of today: mentor feedback captured, Draft 1 planned, stack chosen.

PART 1 · 60 MINUTES

Checkpoint 1

1

Every group demos its digital prototype to its mentor — then turns the feedback into Draft 1.

PART 1 · CHECKPOINT 1

What to show your mentor

01

Problem

What is broken, and why it matters.

02

User

Who will use your app? Be specific.

03

Solution

Your app, in one sentence.

04

3 features

Walk through each one live in your Pixso prototype.

Keep it tight: your mentor sees every group within the hour. Demo the prototype — don't read from notes.

PART 1 · CHECKPOINT 1

Capture the feedback

During your slot

Presenter	Tells the story: problem, user, solution.
Demo driver	Clicks through the Pixso prototype.
Note-taker	Writes down the mentor's feedback, word for word.
Everyone else	Notes the questions you couldn't answer.

Straight after

Agree on the three most important changes, log the feedback in this week's Weekly Log, and build it into Draft 1.



PART 2 · BRIEFING

Draft 1

2

Your problem, your user and your solution — with the evidence of how you got there.

PART 2 · DRAFT 1

Five questions Draft 1 must answer

01	**The problem**	What problem did you choose to solve?
02	**Who has it**	Who experiences this problem, and when?
03	**Your user**	Who will use your digital solution? Not always the person who has the problem.
04	**Size & importance**	How big is the problem, and why is it worth solving? Use light research and cite your sources.
05	**Your solution**	How will your digital prototype solve it? Walk us through it.

PART 2 · DRAFT 1

Show all your work

Put the whole journey into Draft 1 — photos or screenshots of every stage.

Step 1

Notes

Photos of your early notes and research

Step 2

Hand-made sketches

Photos of your paper sketches

Step 3

Visily wireframes wireframes

Screenshots of your wireframes

Step 4

Figma edits

Screenshots of what you changed in Figma

Step 5

Pixso prototype prototype

Screenshots of every screen of your digital prototype

Show how the idea changed at each step. The journey is your evidence — not just the final screens.

PART 2 · DRAFT 1 ·

Submit Draft 1

Any time you are ready — at the latest one day before your Week 5 session.

Build in today's mentor feedback before you submit.

Include the full evidence trail: notes → sketches → Visily → Figma → Pixso.

PART 3 · REST OF THE SESSION

Choose your stack

3

Create your Softr account, start the certification, and decide what you will build with.

PART 3 · MINDSET

Engineers figure it out

In school, problems come with answers in the back of the book. In real products, you invent the solution yourself.

We learn by building

Don't wait until you know everything. Build, fail fast, improve.

Smooth means you're not learning

If everything works first time, you're only following instructions.

Every fix grows your skill

Solving something without being told how is what makes you an engineer.



PART 3 · MINDSET

The engineer's loop

Real engineering doesn't happen through perfection. It happens through iteration.



Then go round again. Embrace every stage — especially the failures.

PART 3 · MINDSET

It will feel uncomfortable

> *"We don't know what to do."*

> *"You didn't teach us how."*

> *"There's no clear answer."*

These are normal, healthy signs that you're leaving your comfort zone. What matters is how you explore, collaborate and adapt.

The 20-minute rule

Spend 20 focused minutes first: ask an AI assistant, search the docs and forums, test variations, note what you tried. Still stuck? Ask for help — and show what you tried.



PART 3 · CHOOSE YOUR STACK

Every app is a stack of decisions

LAYER	WHAT IT DOES	SOFTR'S ANSWER
Front end	Screens, forms and lists users tap	**Softr pages & blocks**
Users & login	Who signs in, and what each one sees	**Softr users & user groups**
Backend logic	What happens after a click	**Softr Workflows**
Database	Where your data lives	**Softr Databases**
AI feature	The advanced feature of your app	**Our API — arrives Week 6**

Softr covers four of the five layers in one free tool — that's why we propose it.

PART 3 · CHOOSE YOUR STACK

Softr's free plan: know the limits

3
builders per workspace

5
app users who can log in

5,000
database records (max 1,000 per database)

500
workflow actions a month

5
Softr AI credits a month

softr.app
web address (no custom domain)

Source: Softr pricing and help docs, September 2026. Limits change — check softr.io/pricing before you plan around them.

PART 3 · CHOOSE YOUR STACK

Get Softr certification

Step 1

Create a free account

At softr.io — no credit card needed.

Step 2

Learn the basics

Watch the Getting Started videos in Softr Academy.

Step 3

Take the exam

At softr.io/certification. It's free.

Step 4

Save your certificate certificate

Add it to your individual contribution evidence.

The Softr exam: 50 questions · 100 minutes · pass mark 80% · up to 3 attempts in 6 months.

PART 3 · CHOOSE YOUR STACK

Other tools are fine — if they stay free

PROPOSED

Softr

Visual blocks, no code

Free: 3 builders, 5 app users

Data: Softr Databases + Workflows

ALLOWED

Bolt.new

Prompt → code

Free: 300K tokens a day, 1M a month

Data: built-in database, or Supabase

ALLOWED

Lovable

Prompt → code

Free: 5 credits a day, max 30 a month

Data: Lovable Cloud, or Supabase

ALLOWED

Base44

Prompt → app

Free: 25 message credits a month, up to 5 apps

Data: built-in database and login

⚠ **Do not enter a credit card** — use free accounts

PART 3 · CHOOSE YOUR STACK

AI inside your app

Your API arrives in Week 6.

We give every group its own AI API.
Don't pay for any AI service.

Prepare now

Pick the feature
Which of your 3 features needs AI?

Define in and out
What does the user give it, and what should come back?

Find the spot
Where in your stack will the AI call happen?

PART 3 · CHOOSE YOUR STACK

Decide your stack — today

Layer	Our choice	Why	Who owns it
App builder	…	…	…
Database	…	…	…
Backend logic	…	…	…
Users & login	…	…	…
AI feature (Week 6 API)	…	…	…

Write it in this week's Weekly Log, then turn each layer into Kanban tasks. You can change your mind later — just record why.

PART 3 · CHOOSE YOUR STACK

Split the learning, share it back

Everyone

Creates a Softr account and gets certified.

Scouts · 1–2 per group

Each tests one free alternative (Bolt.new, Lovable or Base44), then reports back.

Builders · up to 3

If you choose Softr, they hold the seats in the group workspace; everyone else practises in their own. Switch them. Use your own accounts as well to test.

Everyone, every week

Documents what confused them, the errors they hit and how they solved them.



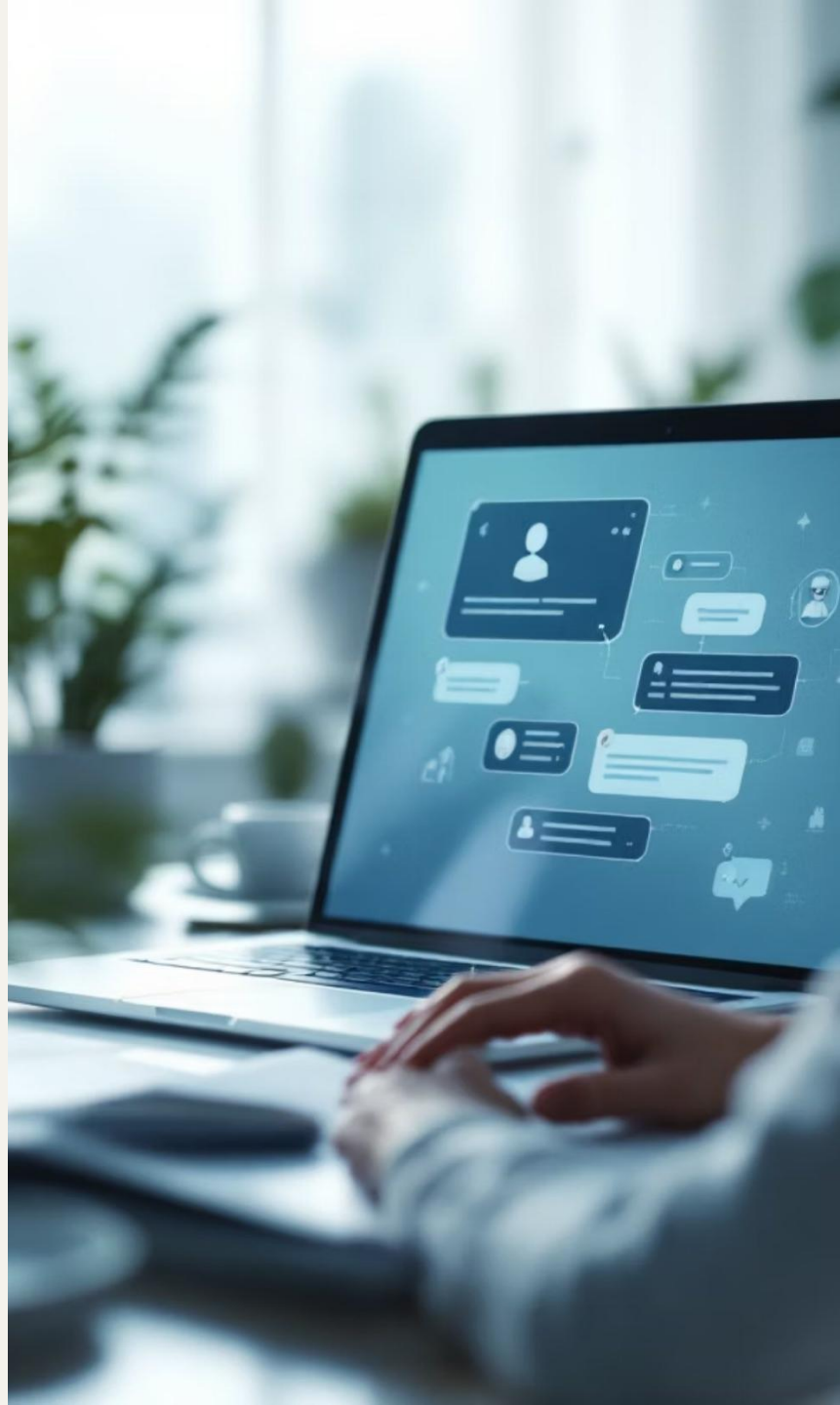
PART 3 · MINDSET

AI is your lab partner

Work with two windows side by side: your builder on the left, your AI assistant on the right.

- **Explore concepts** and make sense of documentation
- **Explain error messages** in plain language
- **Suggest other approaches** when you're stuck
- **Review your logic** and point out gaps

It won't do the engineering for you. The key is asking precise questions — that is an engineering skill in itself.



WRAP-UP

Who to ask for what

External expert
expert

Specific support related to your project.

EEH Mentor
Mentor

Your thinking partner: sharp questions, and feedback at each Checkpoint.

TAs

Admin: submissions, Kanban checks, attendance and group changes.

Stefan

Technical troubleshooting when a platform behaves unexpectedly.

AI assistant

First line, 24/7. Use it inside your 20 minutes, before you ask a person.

Mentors guide your thinking — they won't hand you answers. Finding your own path is the skill you're here to build.

WRAP-UP

Before your Week 5 session

- **Draft 1** submitted on UnoAnalyzer — at the latest one day before your session
- **Softr account** created and certification under way
- **Stack decision** recorded in your Weekly Log
- **Kanban** updated with your first build tasks
- **Individual contribution** documented

Master your tool, share your knowledge, build together.